

TOPIC 6: ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION

1. Meaning of Environmental Protection

Environmental protection is the practice of protecting the natural environment (air, water, soil, plants and animals) from harm caused by human activities. It aims to keep the environment clean, healthy and sustainable for present and future generations.

2. Importance of Environmental Protection

- Ensures clean air and water for good health.
- Preserves soil fertility for food production.
- Protects biodiversity (variety of plants and animals).
- Reduces the effects of climate change and natural disasters.
- Supports tourism and economic development.
- Fulfils our responsibility to future generations.

3. Individual and Community Roles

Individuals can:

- Dispose of waste properly and avoid littering.
- Plant trees and care for them.
- Reduce, reuse and recycle materials.
- Avoid bush burning and pollution of water bodies.
- Use water and energy wisely.
- Educate family and friends about environmental care.

Communities can:

- Organise clean-up campaigns and tree-planting exercises.
- Establish community environmental clubs.
- Protect local forests, streams and open spaces.
- Support and enforce local environmental by-laws.

4. Government Agencies

- **NESREA** (National Environmental Standards and Regulations Enforcement Agency) – enforces environmental laws and standards in Nigeria.
- **FEPA** (Federal Environmental Protection Agency) – earlier agency; functions largely taken over by NESREA.
- State Environmental Protection Agencies / Ministries of Environment.
- Local Government environmental health departments.

These agencies make regulations, monitor pollution, and take action against environmental offenders.

5. Activities that Promote Sustainability

- Afforestation and reforestation programmes
- Proper waste management and recycling
- Use of renewable energy (solar, where possible)
- Sustainable farming (organic methods, contour farming)
- Conservation of water and wildlife
- Environmental education in schools and communities
- Enforcement of environmental laws

6. Summary

Environmental protection keeps the air, water, soil and living things healthy. Individuals, communities and government agencies all have roles to play. Sustainable activities such as tree planting, proper waste disposal and conservation ensure resources remain for the future.

End of Topic 6 – Environmental Protection